

Website Type and Purpose

- Website Type: Portfolio / Educational
- I will create a portfolio style website to showcase my skills and creative ideas for library implementation to potential future employers.

Home Page

- Welcome Statement: Welcome! I'm an energetic educator exploring innovative ideas to bring creativity, curiosity, and connection into the library media center.
- Purpose and Goals: As a current classroom teacher, I'm preparing to transition into the library setting within the next few years. This portfolio highlights the projects, ideas, and instructional approaches that reflect my vision for a vibrant student-centered library. From literacy initiatives to technology integration and community building programs, each piece represents my commitment to fostering a love of learning for all students. Thank you for taking the time to explore my work and ideas. I'm excited to continue growing and look forward to implementing these ideas soon.
- Background/ Highlight Image: A warm inviting workspace - either my current classroom or a library space (plants, soft lighting, creating, collaborating, reading, makerspace?)
- Key Statement / Quote: "Empowering learners through access, inquiry, and imagination."

About/ Educator Credentials

- Hello! My name is Shelly Linhardt, and I'm in my seventeenth year of teaching secondary education. I've taught at both the middle school and high school levels, with experience in reading, science, and most recently family and consumer sciences. My favorite thing about teaching FCS is giving students opportunities to create something they can be proud of. Whether it's a fresh-baked batch of chocolate chip cookies or a hand-sewn tote bag, their pride truly lights me up. I'm currently pursuing an Educational Specialist (Ed.S.) in Learning Technologies and Design at the University of Missouri. Outside of teaching, I'm a mom and a wife, and my family keeps me grounded and energized. My husband and I have three kids, and we love spending time outdoors, especially biking and walking the Katy Trail in Mid-Missouri. I also work

part-time as a pharmacy technician, which provides a calm balance to the lively pace of the classroom.

Headshot



Resume Video Link

- <https://vimeo.com/1160675425>

Project Highlights

- Accessibility and Social Media: ISLT_7310
<https://www.canva.com/design/DAG33j7zyzk/XxcMltYbxQmaAoQHMOGNpw/edit>

Description: This presentation explores how social media can be used to enhance accessibility, engagement, and connection within a school library setting. It highlights best practices for creating inclusive content, designing posts that are readable and user-friendly, and using platform features—such as alt text, captions, and visual contrast—to ensure all users can participate. The project was developed with the long-term goal of creating an Instagram page for the library, focusing on strategies that make information welcoming and accessible to all stakeholders. By combining creativity with thoughtful design, the presentation demonstrates how social media can strengthen a library's reach and impact.

Reflection: Creating this project helped me understand how thoughtful design choices make social media more accessible for all users. I follow many library Instagram pages, and I've seen firsthand how doing social media well can benefit every stakeholder. This process clarified how I can build an inclusive, engaging library presence of my own.

- Cataloging for Children and Young Adults: ISLT_7312

https://www.canva.com/design/DAGWaZ-RILM/Q-kq6hiT_3L51EHyZEYAeQ/edit

Description: This presentation examines current trends in cataloging children's and young adult materials, with a focus on how evolving standards and user needs are shaping modern library practices. It explores shifts toward more inclusive subject headings, improved metadata for diverse formats, and strategies for enhancing discoverability in both physical and digital collections. The presentation also highlights the growing importance of representation, accessibility, and age-appropriate classification as libraries work to better serve young readers. By analyzing these trends, the project emphasizes how thoughtful cataloging can strengthen equity, usability, and engagement across youth collections.

Reflection: Exploring trends in cataloging children's and young adult materials helped me understand how thoughtful classification supports discovery, equity, and representation. I realized how evolving standards and inclusive metadata can better serve young readers. This project strengthened my appreciation for cataloging as a vital part of creating accessible, engaging library collections.

- Technology in Education Blog: ISLT_9467

<https://sites.google.com/d/1oFyRMIUVdixjEa1p-nitSpm-uE8rg7pO/p/12v0VZ1t-NEbevoj4WkazwxHhClzp3Flp/edit>

Description: This blog explores the evolving role of technology in today's classrooms and how digital tools can meaningfully enhance teaching and learning. It highlights practical strategies for integrating technology in ways that support student engagement, accessibility, and creativity. Throughout the blog, I reflect on emerging trends, evaluate tools that promote collaboration and

critical thinking, and consider how thoughtful tech integration can empower both teachers and students. The project also allowed me to connect my own experiences with broader conversations in educational technology, strengthening my understanding of how digital innovation can shape more inclusive and dynamic learning environments.

Reflection: Working on this blog deepened my understanding of how technology can enhance teaching while also shifting my perspective on the balance between digital and paper-based learning. Reflecting on tools and trends helped me connect research to practice and strengthened my ability to design engaging, accessible, and purposeful learning experiences.

Personal Reflection / Teaching Philosophy

My experiences throughout this program have reshaped how I think about teaching, learning, and the role of information in students' lives. Each course has pushed me to consider how design, accessibility, and digital tools can support deeper engagement and more equitable access to resources. These ideas naturally align with the work of a library media specialist, where thoughtful curation and intentional technology use are essential.

Across my seventeen years in education, I've taught multiple content areas and grade levels, which has given me a broad understanding of student needs and learning styles. My experience in literacy, science and family and consumer sciences, in particular, has strengthened my ability to design hands-on, inquiry-based learning experiences—skills that translate directly to makerspaces, research instruction, and collaborative library programming. Creating digital content, managing classroom resources, and supporting students as they develop real-world skills all mirror the multifaceted responsibilities of a modern school library.

Pursuing an Educational Specialist degree in Learning Technologies and Design has further prepared me for this transition. The program has deepened my understanding of accessible design, digital literacy, and instructional technology integration—core components of today's library media field. I've gained experience evaluating digital tools, creating inclusive online content, and analyzing trends in information access. These skills will allow me to support both students and teachers as they navigate an increasingly digital learning environment.

At the heart of my teaching philosophy is the belief that students thrive when they feel capable, curious, and empowered to explore. A school library is uniquely positioned to nurture those qualities by providing access to diverse resources, fostering a love of reading, and offering a safe space for creativity and discovery. My goal is to build a library environment where every student feels welcome, represented, and inspired. Transitioning into the library media field feels like a natural next step—one that allows me to combine my passion for learning, technology, and student empowerment in a meaningful new way.

AI was used to create my resume video in powtoon, to clarify my ideas, and stylise my writing for a professional audience.